

# Approbation Document Checklist

## German Medical License

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Professional checklist, trackers, state comparison,  
authentication guide, translations, and German cover letter



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Use this document as a preparation checklist. State authorities can change forms, fees, document age limits, and translation rules. Before submission, compare every item against the current checklist of the competent authority for the federal state where you can prove jurisdiction.

# Introduction: how the Approbation process works

Approbation is the unrestricted German medical licence. It is required for independent work as a physician in Germany and is issued by the competent authority of a German federal state. The federal licence is valid throughout Germany after it is granted, but the application is processed by a specific state authority.

For doctors trained outside Germany, the authority checks whether the medical qualification is equivalent to the German medical qualification. If substantial differences are found or the applicant chooses the examination pathway where available, the Kenntnisprüfung may be required. Separate from professional equivalence, applicants must usually prove identity, completed medical training, reliability, medical fitness, German language ability, and state jurisdiction or intention to work in that state.

This guide is written for non-EU / third-country trained doctors preparing an application package. EU/EEA/Swiss applicants often use different automatic-recognition rules and may need additional certificates such as a certificate of conformity. Always use the state-specific checklist that matches your training country and intended workplace.

## Core process map

| Step                              | Action                                                                                                                                                           |
|-----------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1. Choose state                   | Select the state where you can prove residence, job offer, interviews, applications, or other intention to work.                                                 |
| 2. Download official form         | Use the current form from the authority website; do not reuse old PDFs from social media.                                                                        |
| 3. Prepare documents              | Collect identity, civil-status, degree, transcript, internship, licence, good standing, employment, language, health and police documents.                       |
| 4. Authenticate foreign documents | Use apostille if the issuing country participates in the Hague Apostille Convention and the German authority accepts it; otherwise legalisation may be required. |
| 5. Translate                      | Use a qualified/sworn translator according to the state authority rules. Many authorities require German translations even for English documents.                |
| 6. Submit complete package        | Submit online or by post as instructed. Incomplete applications often trigger delay letters or return of the file.                                               |
| 7. Equivalence/FSP/KP pathway     | Complete language exam/FSP and, if required, the Kenntnisprüfung or other equivalence steps.                                                                     |
| 8. Final decision                 | Authority grants Approbation after all requirements are complete and current.                                                                                    |

### Important limit

This PDF is a preparation tool, not legal advice and not a substitute for the official authority checklist. Requirements differ by state, application route, country of training, and personal history.

# Master 22-item checklist

Use this as the central control sheet. Mark each item only after checking both the original and the German translation/certification requirement.

|     |                                                                                                                                                                            |
|-----|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 01. | Completed current Approbation application form for the chosen federal state.                                                                                               |
| 02. | Signed, dated tabular CV in German with no unexplained gaps.                                                                                                               |
| 03. | Valid passport or national ID copy in the required certification form.                                                                                                     |
| 04. | Birth certificate with full name and parent details where required.                                                                                                        |
| 05. | Marriage certificate, divorce certificate, or name-change proof, if current name differs from birth/degree documents.                                                      |
| 06. | Proof of jurisdiction/intention to work in the state, such as residence registration, job offer, applications, interview invitations, or state-specific counselling proof. |
| 07. | Medical degree certificate / diploma.                                                                                                                                      |
| 08. | Final examination certificate, if separate from the degree certificate.                                                                                                    |
| 09. | Transcript of records with subjects, grades, hours, and clinical rotations if available.                                                                                   |
| 10. | Curriculum/syllabus or study-record evidence showing content and duration of medical education.                                                                            |
| 11. | Internship / house job / practical-year certificates with departments and dates.                                                                                           |
| 12. | Licence/registration to practise medicine in the country of training or last practice country.                                                                             |
| 13. | Certificate of good standing / certificate of current professional status from medical council or authority.                                                               |
| 14. | Employment certificates for each medical job after graduation.                                                                                                             |
| 15. | German B2 certificate from an accepted provider, if required at this stage.                                                                                                |
| 16. | Fachsprachprüfung registration, invitation, pass certificate, or state-specific proof.                                                                                     |
| 17. | German police certificate / Führungszeugnis, if already resident in Germany and requested.                                                                                 |
| 18. | Foreign police clearance / certificate of no criminal record from home/study/work countries where required.                                                                |
| 19. | Medical fitness certificate using the state authority template or wording.                                                                                                 |
| 20. | Official certifications of copies according to the authority rules.                                                                                                        |
| 21. | Apostille or embassy/consular legalisation for foreign public documents where required.                                                                                    |
| 22. | Qualified German translations attached behind each foreign-language document.                                                                                              |

## Control fields

| Field                                         | Your entry |
|-----------------------------------------------|------------|
| Chosen state                                  |            |
| Competent authority                           |            |
| Application route: EU/third country           |            |
| Submission method: online/post/in person      |            |
| Date official checklist downloaded            |            |
| Name consistency checked across all documents |            |
| Oldest time-limited document expiry date      |            |

# Category 1: Identity and civil-status documents

Identity documents establish who you are and explain any name differences between civil records, educational records, passport, and professional licences. Name mismatch is one of the most preventable causes of delay.

|  |                                                                                                                                                              |
|--|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|  | Valid passport: copy all required data pages; check whether the authority wants a simple copy, certified copy, or original inspection.                       |
|  | Birth certificate: use a long-form certificate if the authority requires parent names or birthplace details.                                                 |
|  | Marriage certificate: required if your current name differs from the birth certificate or degree documents.                                                  |
|  | Divorce certificate / court order: required if it explains a legal name change or marital-status change relevant to current name.                            |
|  | Name-change declaration: include any official name-change deed, gazette notification, or court certificate if applicable.                                    |
|  | Proof of residence in Germany: Meldebescheinigung, if already registered in Germany and accepted as jurisdiction proof.                                      |
|  | Proof of intention to work: applications, interview invitations, employment promise, hospital correspondence, or counselling proof depending on state rules. |
|  | Signed CV in German: tabular format, dated and signed; include month/year for education, internship, employment, gaps, and language study.                   |
|  | Statement about previous German applications: some authorities require declaration whether you applied in another German state.                              |
|  | Contact sheet: current email, phone number, postal address, and authorised representative if using one.                                                      |

## Name consistency audit

| Document                 | Name shown | DOB           | Correction / explanation |
|--------------------------|------------|---------------|--------------------------|
| Document                 | Name shown | Date of birth | Action needed            |
| Passport                 |            |               |                          |
| Birth certificate        |            |               |                          |
| Degree certificate       |            |               |                          |
| Medical council licence  |            |               |                          |
| Employment certificate 1 |            |               |                          |
| Language certificate     |            |               |                          |

## Category 2: Medical qualifications

Medical qualification evidence is used to confirm that the applicant completed a recognised medical education and to compare the content/duration with German medical education. Keep this category organised in chronological order from admission to graduation to internship.

|  |                                                                                                                                            |
|--|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|  | Medical degree / diploma certificate.                                                                                                      |
|  | Final exam certificate or university-issued completion certificate, if separate.                                                           |
|  | Transcript of records with subjects, grades, credits/hours, and examination results.                                                       |
|  | Detailed syllabus/curriculum with theoretical and clinical subjects, clinical rotation duration, and assessment format.                    |
|  | Internship / house officer / practical year certificate with dates, departments, and full-time/part-time status.                           |
|  | Dean letter or university confirmation if the internship is integrated into the degree programme.                                          |
|  | Licence to practise / permanent registration certificate from medical council.                                                             |
|  | Temporary/provisional registration certificate, if applicable.                                                                             |
|  | Certificate of good standing / professional status from licensing authority or medical council.                                            |
|  | Evidence of completed postgraduate training, courses, ACLS/BLS, CME, or specialty rotations if relevant.                                   |
|  | Certificate of conformity for EU/EEA/Swiss routes where applicable; not usually a third-country document unless the authority requests it. |
|  | Official explanation of grading scale or ECTS/credit system, if the transcript is not self-explanatory.                                    |

### Qualification evidence tracker

| Item                   | Orig.              | Cert.          | Auth.                  | Trans.      | Notes |
|------------------------|--------------------|----------------|------------------------|-------------|-------|
| Item                   | Original available | Certified copy | Apostille/legalisation | Translation | Notes |
| Degree certificate     |                    |                |                        |             |       |
| Transcript             |                    |                |                        |             |       |
| Syllabus/curriculum    |                    |                |                        |             |       |
| Internship certificate |                    |                |                        |             |       |
| Medical licence        |                    |                |                        |             |       |
| Good standing          |                    |                |                        |             |       |

# Category 3: Employment history documents

Employment documents help explain professional experience, confirm practice rights, and support CV chronology. They may also be relevant if the authority evaluates professional experience to compensate for substantial differences.

|  |                                                                                                                                                             |
|--|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|  | Employment certificate from every hospital/clinic listed in the CV.                                                                                         |
|  | Certificates should show job title, department, start date, end date, working hours, and core duties.                                                       |
|  | Internship employment/practical training letter, if separate from university internship certificate.                                                        |
|  | Experience letter for emergency, internal medicine, surgery, paediatrics, obstetrics/gynaecology, psychiatry, and community medicine rotations if relevant. |
|  | Payslips or contract copies only if the authority requests additional proof of employment.                                                                  |
|  | Recommendation letters are optional unless requested; use them only as supporting evidence, not as substitute for formal employment certificates.           |
|  | Gaps longer than one month should be explained in the CV: language course, exam preparation, family leave, unemployment, travel, or visa waiting period.    |
|  | Keep employment certificates consistent with medical council good-standing dates and licence validity.                                                      |
|  | If self-employed, prepare clinic registration, professional licence, tax/business proof, and professional liability evidence if requested.                  |
|  | If never employed after internship, write a clear CV note: German language preparation / Approbation preparation / no clinical work since date.             |

## CV gap audit

| Period | CV activity           | Proof           | Risk       | Fix |
|--------|-----------------------|-----------------|------------|-----|
| Period | Activity stated in CV | Proof available | Risk level | Fix |
|        |                       |                 |            |     |
|        |                       |                 |            |     |
|        |                       |                 |            |     |
|        |                       |                 |            |     |

# Category 4: Language certificates

Language requirements are state-specific. The common practical pattern is general German at B2 level plus a medical German Fachsprachprüfung at C1 medical communication level, but exact providers, validity periods, and submission timing vary by state.

|  |                                                                                                                                                                    |
|--|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|  | General German B2 certificate from a provider accepted by the chosen authority. Examples may include Goethe-Institut, telc, or TestDaF depending on the authority. |
|  | Higher certificate such as Goethe C1 or telc C1 may strengthen the file, but it does not automatically replace the Fachsprachprüfung unless the authority says so. |
|  | Fachsprachprüfung registration confirmation, invitation, result letter, or pass certificate from the responsible Ärztekammer or testing body.                      |
|  | Check certificate age limits. Some authorities specify validity periods for language evidence.                                                                     |
|  | Ensure the name and date of birth on the certificate match the passport and application form.                                                                      |
|  | If certificate provider uses digital verification, print the verification page or include the verification code if accepted.                                       |
|  | Keep copies of exam appointment emails and payment receipts for timeline tracking.                                                                                 |
|  | Do not submit an expired or unofficial language screenshot as final proof unless the authority explicitly accepts it.                                              |
|  | Prepare German medical communication documents: Anamnese structure, Arztbrief phrases, patient-friendly explanations, handover phrases.                            |
|  | Track FSP retake rules and waiting periods in the selected state.                                                                                                  |

## Language readiness tracker

| Requirement                     | Status | Provider           | Date | Expiry          | Next step |
|---------------------------------|--------|--------------------|------|-----------------|-----------|
| Requirement                     | Status | Provider/Authority | Date | Expiry/validity | Next step |
| B2 German                       |        |                    |      |                 |           |
| C1 German, optional             |        |                    |      |                 |           |
| Fachsprachprüfung               |        |                    |      |                 |           |
| Medical terminology preparation |        |                    |      |                 |           |
| Patient communication practice  |        |                    |      |                 |           |



# State-by-state comparison table

The following table is a planning comparison. It is not a substitute for the live state checklist. “Authority focus” means the office most commonly involved for third-country physician Approbation or recognition procedures, but responsibility can differ by route, residence, and state rules.

| State               | Likely authority focus                                                                 | Document focus                                                                                                                               | Planning notes                                                                |
|---------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Bayern              | Regierung von Oberbayern / ZABY for many foreign health-profession files               | Proof of intended work in Bavaria; certified copies; degree/training evidence; language/FSP; health and reliability evidence                 | Known for detailed forms and strict document-format expectations.             |
| Nordrhein-Westfalen | Bezirksregierung Münster, ZAG-aH for third-country applicants intending to work in NRW | State-wide NRW processing for third-country applicants; proof of jurisdiction; qualified translations; apostille/legalisation may be checked | Longer processing times possible; complete submission is strongly emphasised. |
| Berlin              | LAGeSo / Landesprüfungsamt for health professions                                      | Proof of Berlin jurisdiction; signed CV; identity; birth/name documents; police/good standing; medical fitness; B2; FSP C1                   | Berlin publishes fee and estimated processing time when complete.             |
| Hessen              | Hessian state recognition / administrative portal route                                | Foreign professional qualification recognition; state jurisdiction; health/reliability/language/equivalence checks                           | Use the portal checklist for the exact authority and form.                    |
| Hamburg             | Hamburg Landesprüfungsamt / city service route                                         | Third-country qualification recognition; reliability; health; language; documents according to Hamburg form                                  | Hamburg states Approbation is unlimited and valid Germany-wide once granted.  |
| Baden-Württemberg   | Regierungspräsidium Stuttgart / LPA route                                              | Proof of intended activity or residence/counselling proof; identity; qualifications; translations                                            | Current application PDFs specify which copy/translation form is needed.       |
| Niedersachsen       | NiZZA / state health authority route                                                   | State-specific forms, equivalence, language/FSP, health and reliability evidence                                                             | Check whether documents are submitted online or by post.                      |
| Sachsen             | Landesdirektion Sachsen route                                                          | State jurisdiction, medical qualification, good standing, health, reliability, language/FSP                                                  | Use state application pack and current fee schedule.                          |
| Thüringen           | Thüringer Landesverwaltungsamt route                                                   | Medical qualification recognition and occupational licensing documents                                                                       | Check whether direct KP or equivalence report options are available.          |
| Schleswig-Holstein  | Landesamt / health professions recognition route                                       | Identity, qualifications, reliability, health, language/FSP, jurisdiction proof                                                              | State may require specific medical fitness wording.                           |
| Rheinland-Pfalz     | Landesamt für Soziales, Jugend und Versorgung route                                    | Approbation/temporary permit files; equivalence/language/reliability checks                                                                  | Check documents required for Berufserlaubnis versus Approbation.              |
| Saarland            | State health authority route                                                           | Application form, identity, qualification, language, health, reliability, jurisdiction proof                                                 | Small state; verify current contact point before submission.                  |

Practical rule: choose the state where you can prove a genuine connection. Submitting to a state without jurisdiction proof can lead to rejection, non-processing, or requests to withdraw and transfer the file.

# State comparison: decision worksheet

Use this worksheet before committing to a state. Do not choose only by rumours about difficulty. A faster state with no jurisdiction proof can become slower than a strict state where your file is complete.

| Criterion                                  | Bayern | NRW | Berlin | Hessen | Other |
|--------------------------------------------|--------|-----|--------|--------|-------|
| Can prove residence/job/interviews?        |        |     |        |        |       |
| Official checklist found and saved?        |        |     |        |        |       |
| Accepts your intended submission format?   |        |     |        |        |       |
| Language/FSP schedule realistic?           |        |     |        |        |       |
| Known copy certification rules understood? |        |     |        |        |       |
| Estimated processing time acceptable?      |        |     |        |        |       |
| Cost of translations/syllabus manageable?  |        |     |        |        |       |
| Backup state if jurisdiction changes?      |        |     |        |        |       |

## Questions to answer before submission

|                          |                                                                                                             |
|--------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <input type="checkbox"/> | Do I have written proof that this state is responsible for my case?                                         |
| <input type="checkbox"/> | Do I know whether the authority wants originals, certified copies, simple copies, scans, or online uploads? |
| <input type="checkbox"/> | Do I know which documents must be no older than 3 months at submission?                                     |
| <input type="checkbox"/> | Do I know whether English documents still need German translation?                                          |
| <input type="checkbox"/> | Do I know whether the authority accepts translations done outside Germany?                                  |
| <input type="checkbox"/> | Do I know the exact FSP authority and how to register?                                                      |
| <input type="checkbox"/> | Do I know whether Berufserlaubnis can be applied for together with Approbation?                             |
| <input type="checkbox"/> | Do I know how to withdraw/transfer a file if changing states?                                               |

# Authentication guide: apostille vs embassy legalisation

Authentication proves that a public document is genuine. It is separate from translation and copy certification. A document can require all three: original/certified copy, authentication, and German translation.

| Concept                       | Use when                                                                                                    | Typical authority                                                                         | Common mistake                                                                                                     |
|-------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Concept                       | Use when                                                                                                    | Typical authority                                                                         | Common mistake                                                                                                     |
| Apostille                     | The issuing country is a Hague Apostille Convention member and Germany accepts apostille for that document. | Designated apostille authority in the issuing country.                                    | Getting a notary stamp instead of an apostille on the public document.                                             |
| Embassy/consular legalisation | Apostille is not available or not accepted for that country/document.                                       | German embassy/consulate after local pre-authentication chain.                            | Skipping the ministry/legalisation chain before embassy appointment.                                               |
| Certified copy                | Authority does not keep originals but needs a certified copy of an original document.                       | German authority, notary, municipality, or recognised certifier depending on state rules. | Certifying a copy of an uncertified scan or using a non-accepted certifier.                                        |
| Sworn/qualified translation   | Foreign-language document must be read by German authority.                                                 | Translator accepted under state rules; often publicly appointed/sworn translator.         | Translating before apostille/legalisation when the authority wants the authentication included in the translation. |

## Authentication decision tree

|  |                                                                                                                                                            |
|--|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|  | Is this a public document such as birth certificate, marriage certificate, police clearance, degree, or licence? If yes, check authentication requirement. |
|  | Was the document issued in Germany? If yes, foreign-document authentication usually does not apply; copy certification may still apply.                    |
|  | Was the document issued abroad? Check whether the state authority asks for apostille/legalisation for that document type.                                  |
|  | Is the issuing country in the Hague Apostille Convention? If yes, apostille may be the correct route.                                                      |
|  | If no apostille route exists, check the German embassy legalisation process and any required pre-certification by local ministries.                        |
|  | After authentication, translate the document plus apostille/legalisation page if the authority requires the authentication text to be translated.          |
|  | Keep the original, authenticated copy, translation, and certified copy together as one document bundle.                                                    |

# Translation requirements

Translation rules differ by state. Many authorities require qualified German translations for foreign-language documents, including documents originally written in English. Some authorities accept translations from sworn translators in Germany; others may accept foreign sworn translators only under specific conditions.

|  |                                                                                                                                              |
|--|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|  | Check whether translation must be completed by a publicly appointed/sworn translator in Germany.                                             |
|  | Ask whether translations prepared abroad are accepted; do not assume acceptance.                                                             |
|  | Translate the complete document, including stamps, signatures, seals, back pages, apostille, and legalisation notes.                         |
|  | Keep translation attached to the certified/authenticated document it belongs to.                                                             |
|  | Do not translate from a photocopy if the translator requires the original or certified copy.                                                 |
|  | Use consistent spelling of your name across translations; match passport and official transliteration where possible.                        |
|  | If the original contains abbreviations, ask the translator to preserve and explain them where needed.                                        |
|  | If the university syllabus is very long, ask the authority whether full translation is required or whether a structured summary is accepted. |
|  | Do not laminate originals; authorities and translators may reject altered or damaged documents.                                              |
|  | Scan translations in readable PDF quality, not compressed images.                                                                            |

## Translation bundle structure

| Order | Document bundle                                               |
|-------|---------------------------------------------------------------|
| Order | Document bundle                                               |
| 1     | Certified/authenticated copy of original document             |
| 2     | Apostille/legalisation page, if separate                      |
| 3     | German translation of the full original document              |
| 4     | German translation of the apostille/legalisation, if required |
| 5     | Translator certification page/stamp/signature                 |
| 6     | Your file index number and document number                    |

# Timeline tracker with estimated durations

The estimates below are planning ranges only. Real time depends on country of issue, state backlog, exam availability, completeness of file, and whether equivalence assessment or Kenntnisprüfung is required.

| Task                                          | Planning estimate                                          | Start | Target | Done | Notes |
|-----------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------|-------|--------|------|-------|
| Collect passport/civil documents              | 1-4 weeks                                                  |       |        |      |       |
| Request university degree/transcript/syllabus | 2-12 weeks                                                 |       |        |      |       |
| Request medical council licence/good standing | 1-8 weeks                                                  |       |        |      |       |
| Police clearance / reliability documents      | 1-8 weeks                                                  |       |        |      |       |
| Apostille/legalisation chain                  | 2-12 weeks                                                 |       |        |      |       |
| Translations                                  | 1-8 weeks depending on volume                              |       |        |      |       |
| Medical fitness certificate                   | 1 week; keep within authority age limit                    |       |        |      |       |
| German B2 preparation/exam                    | Variable; often months                                     |       |        |      |       |
| FSP registration/preparation/exam             | Variable by state/exam availability                        |       |        |      |       |
| Authority processing after complete file      | State-specific; Berlin states about 3-4 months if complete |       |        |      |       |
| Kenntnisprüfung preparation/exam if required  | Variable; often several months                             |       |        |      |       |

## Time-limited documents

Police clearances, good standing certificates, and medical fitness certificates are commonly time-limited. Some authorities use a three-month limit at submission or presentation. Order these late enough to remain valid, but early enough to avoid blocking submission.

# Cost tracker table

Costs vary heavily by country, document volume, translator, state, and exam pathway. Enter actual quotes before spending. The purpose of this tracker is to stop hidden costs from surprising you after you have already started.

| Cost item                                 | Estimated range | Actual | Paid | Receipt saved | Notes |
|-------------------------------------------|-----------------|--------|------|---------------|-------|
| University transcripts/syllabus           |                 |        |      |               |       |
| Medical council licence/good standing     |                 |        |      |               |       |
| Police clearances                         |                 |        |      |               |       |
| Apostille/legalisation fees               |                 |        |      |               |       |
| Courier/postage                           |                 |        |      |               |       |
| Certified copies/notary                   |                 |        |      |               |       |
| German translations - certificates        |                 |        |      |               |       |
| German translations - syllabus/curriculum |                 |        |      |               |       |
| Approbation application fee               |                 |        |      |               |       |
| Fachsprachprüfung fee                     |                 |        |      |               |       |
| Kenntnisprüfung fee, if required          |                 |        |      |               |       |
| Language exam B2/C1 fee                   |                 |        |      |               |       |
| Medical fitness certificate               |                 |        |      |               |       |
| Travel/accommodation for exams            |                 |        |      |               |       |
| Adviser/lawyer, optional                  |                 |        |      |               |       |

## Budget discipline

|  |                                                                                                                              |
|--|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|  | Never pay to translate a full syllabus before confirming that the selected authority requires the full syllabus translation. |
|  | Prioritise documents with long processing times first, but delay short-validity documents until close to submission.         |
|  | Keep receipts and file numbers. They help with reimbursement, tax records, and follow-up emails.                             |

# Common delay points and how to avoid them

| Delay point                 | Why it happens                                                                  | Avoidance step                                                                                                           |
|-----------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Delay point                 | Why it happens                                                                  | Avoidance step                                                                                                           |
| Wrong state jurisdiction    | Applicant cannot prove residence/intention to work in the state.                | Collect job applications, interview invitations, employment promise, registration, or counselling proof before applying. |
| Name mismatch               | Passport, birth certificate, degree, and licence use different spellings.       | Prepare marriage/name-change proof and a one-page name explanation.                                                      |
| Expired documents           | Police clearance, good standing, or medical certificate older than allowed.     | Track issue date and expiry; order short-validity documents late.                                                        |
| Incomplete syllabus         | Authority cannot compare training content/duration.                             | Request detailed curriculum early and ask university for official stamp/signature.                                       |
| Wrong copy form             | Simple copy submitted when certified copy/original required.                    | Make a document matrix: original, certified copy, simple copy, upload.                                                   |
| Translation rejected        | Translator not accepted or translation incomplete.                              | Use accepted sworn/qualified translator and translate stamps/seals/back pages.                                           |
| Authentication missing      | Foreign certificate lacks apostille/legalisation.                               | Check country/document-specific authentication before translation.                                                       |
| Unclear CV gaps             | Authority cannot follow timeline after graduation.                              | Use month/year CV and explain every gap neutrally.                                                                       |
| Language proof timing       | Applicant submits without clear FSP/B2 pathway.                                 | Check whether language proof can be submitted later and keep registration evidence.                                      |
| Multiple state applications | Files become difficult to transfer; authority may require withdrawal elsewhere. | Avoid parallel unclear applications unless officially advised.                                                           |

## Pre-submission quality control

|  |                                                                                                                |
|--|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|  | Every document listed in the official checklist is present or clearly marked as allowed to be submitted later. |
|  | Every foreign-language document has a German translation if required.                                          |
|  | Every time-limited document is still valid on the planned submission date.                                     |
|  | Every certified copy is complete and readable, including reverse pages and seals.                              |
|  | Application form, CV, and cover letter use the same address, phone, email, and name spelling.                  |

# Sample cover letter in German

Use this as a template. Replace bracketed text. Keep the final version concise and consistent with your attached documents.

[Ihr Vorname Nachname]

[Ihre Anschrift]

[E-Mail] | [Telefon]

An [Name der zuständigen Behörde]

[Adresse der Behörde]

[Ort], den [Datum]

Betreff: Antrag auf Erteilung der Approbation als Ärztin/Arzt

Sehr geehrte Damen und Herren,

hiermit beantrage ich die Erteilung der Approbation als Ärztin/Arzt. Meine ärztliche Ausbildung habe ich an der [Name der Universität] in [Land] abgeschlossen. Ich beabsichtige, im Bundesland [Bundesland] als Ärztin/Arzt tätig zu werden. Den entsprechenden Nachweis der Zuständigkeit habe ich beigefügt.

Die erforderlichen Unterlagen füge ich diesem Antrag gemäß der aktuellen Checkliste bei. Fremdsprachige Unterlagen wurden, soweit erforderlich, mit qualifizierter deutscher Übersetzung eingereicht. Beglaubigungen sowie Nachweise zur Echtheit ausländischer Urkunden sind den jeweiligen Dokumenten beigefügt.

Sollten weitere Unterlagen oder ergänzende Informationen erforderlich sein, bitte ich um schriftliche Mitteilung an die oben genannte E-Mail-Adresse.

Mit freundlichen Grüßen

[Unterschrift]

[Ihr Vorname Nachname]

## Attachment list template

| No. | Attachment                                        | Included |
|-----|---------------------------------------------------|----------|
| No. | Anlage                                            | Included |
| 1   | Antragsformular                                   |          |
| 2   | Tabellarischer Lebenslauf                         |          |
| 3   | Reisepass / Identitätsnachweis                    |          |
| 4   | Geburtsurkunde / Namensnachweis                   |          |
| 5   | Nachweis der Zuständigkeit                        |          |
| 6   | Diplom / Abschlusszeugnis                         |          |
| 7   | Transcript / Studiennachweise                     |          |
| 8   | Praktikums-/Internship-Nachweise                  |          |
| 9   | Berufszulassung / Certificate of Good Standing    |          |
| 10  | Sprachzertifikate / FSP-Nachweise                 |          |
| 11  | Führungszeugnisse / Straffreiheitsbescheinigungen |          |
| 12  | Ärztliches Attest                                 |          |



# Final application assembly checklist

Use this page immediately before submission or mailing.

|                          |                                                                                                          |
|--------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <input type="checkbox"/> | Printed application form is the newest version from the authority website.                               |
| <input type="checkbox"/> | Form is signed and dated in all required places.                                                         |
| <input type="checkbox"/> | CV is signed and dated and has no unexplained gaps.                                                      |
| <input type="checkbox"/> | Documents are ordered exactly like the authority checklist or numbered attachment list.                  |
| <input type="checkbox"/> | Each original/certified copy is complete, readable, and includes back pages and seals.                   |
| <input type="checkbox"/> | Each foreign document has the required authentication: apostille, legalisation, or none if not required. |
| <input type="checkbox"/> | Each foreign-language document has the required German translation.                                      |
| <input type="checkbox"/> | Translator stamp/signature/certification is visible and readable.                                        |
| <input type="checkbox"/> | Short-validity documents are still valid on submission date.                                             |
| <input type="checkbox"/> | Passport copy is valid and readable.                                                                     |
| <input type="checkbox"/> | Proof of state jurisdiction is included.                                                                 |
| <input type="checkbox"/> | Language/FSP proof is included or clearly allowed to follow later.                                       |
| <input type="checkbox"/> | You saved a complete scanned copy of the entire submitted package.                                       |
| <input type="checkbox"/> | You saved proof of postage/upload confirmation/email confirmation.                                       |
| <input type="checkbox"/> | You recorded file number, contact email, and follow-up date.                                             |
| <input type="checkbox"/> | You did not submit irreplaceable originals unless the authority explicitly requires originals.           |
| <input type="checkbox"/> | You used a reliable postal/courier method if mailing physical documents.                                 |
| <input type="checkbox"/> | You included a cover letter and attachment list.                                                         |
| <input type="checkbox"/> | You kept a separate expiry tracker for police, good standing, and medical fitness documents.             |
| <input type="checkbox"/> | You have a plan for FSP/KP dates, preparation, and retakes if needed.                                    |

## Submission log

| Field                             | Entry                     |
|-----------------------------------|---------------------------|
| Date submitted                    |                           |
| Method                            | Online / post / in person |
| Tracking number                   |                           |
| Authority file number             |                           |
| Contact email                     |                           |
| Expected first response date      |                           |
| Documents allowed to follow later |                           |

# Sources and verification notes

This checklist was prepared from official or authority-level information available at creation time. Verify all state-specific details again before submission.

| Source                                                 | Used for                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
|--------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Recognition Portal - Doctor of medicine                | States that foreign-trained doctors need Approbation, the unrestricted occupational licence, to practise as doctors in Germany.                                                                                                                                                                        |
| Berlin Service Portal - Approbation, third country     | Lists Berlin prerequisites and required documents including equivalence/knowledge proof, health suitability, reliability, B2 German, Fachsprachentest, jurisdiction proof, CV, identity, birth certificate, police/good standing and medical fitness documents; publishes fee and processing estimate. |
| Anerkennung in Deutschland - Documents for application | Lists common recognition documents: degree, training content/duration, German CV, employment proof, intention to work, medical fitness, reliability, German language, specialist language examination, and entitlement to practise.                                                                    |
| Bezirksregierung Münster - Drittstaat                  | States NRW-wide competence for third-country applicants intending to work in NRW, emphasises complete files, qualified translations for foreign-language documents, and apostille/legalisation where required.                                                                                         |
| Hamburg Service Portal - third-country doctors         | States Approbation is needed to work as a doctor and is valid throughout Germany; lists core requirements including qualification equivalence, reliability, health and language.                                                                                                                       |

URLs checked: [anerkennung-in-deutschland.de](https://anerkennung-in-deutschland.de); [service.berlin.de](https://service.berlin.de); [bezreg-muenster.de](https://bezreg-muenster.de); [hamburg.de](https://hamburg.de); [service-bw.de](https://service-bw.de). Because authority pages change, keep a saved PDF/screenshot of the state checklist you rely on for your own application file.